Activity:

Evaluative Reading Questions

(Focus: judgement, critique, values, effectiveness, author's intent)

1. Do you think the author presents urban isolation as a tragedy or a choice? Justify with evidence from the story.
2. Is the ending of the story emotionally satisfying? Why or why not?
3. Evaluate the effectiveness of silence as a narrative tool in the novella. How does it shape your understanding of Ravi and Smita?
4. Does the story support the idea that brief human interactions can be deeply transformative? Give reasons.
5. Assess the credibility and relatability of the characters. Are their behaviors realistic within an urban Indian context?
6. What implicit message does the author convey about healing and human connection in modern life? Is this message optimistic or melancholic?
7. Does the story challenge or reinforce gender stereotypes in Indian urban settings? Support your evaluation.

Extrapolative Reading Questions

(Focus: predictions, extensions, application, hypothetical scenarios)

1. Imagine the story continues a year later. What might Ravi and Smita's relationship look like? Write a short continuation.
2. How would this story change if it were set in a rural apartment complex rather than an urban one?
3. Suppose Smita writes a letter to her former fiancé after meeting Ravi. What would she say?
4. What if the lift never malfunctioned how would their lives have continued in isolation? What does this suggest about chance encounters?
5. Design a short film adaptation of this story. What cinematic techniques would you use to highlight silence and empathy?
6. Create a metaphor that captures the central theme of the story, such as "The Lift is to connection as ___ is to ___." Explain your reasoning.
7. How might AI-driven social platforms misinterpret or fail to capture the depth of the interaction between Ravi and Smita?